

BOX UNITED



Box United is a 501(c)3 nonprofit organization that uses the sport of boxing to help students become leaders in life. Our award-winning, research-backed program, **Fight Like a Girl**, is designed to directly address the challenges girls are facing, while helping them master the fundamentals of boxing. **We know that boxing changes lives.** We can't wait for you to become part of this mission.

High Level Impact

- 95% of girls say FLAG is a safe space
- 76% feel stronger and more physically powerful
- 85% report growing confidence in leadership
- 90% better regulate their emotions under stress
- [Girls Opportunity Alliance 2024 Grant Recipient](#)

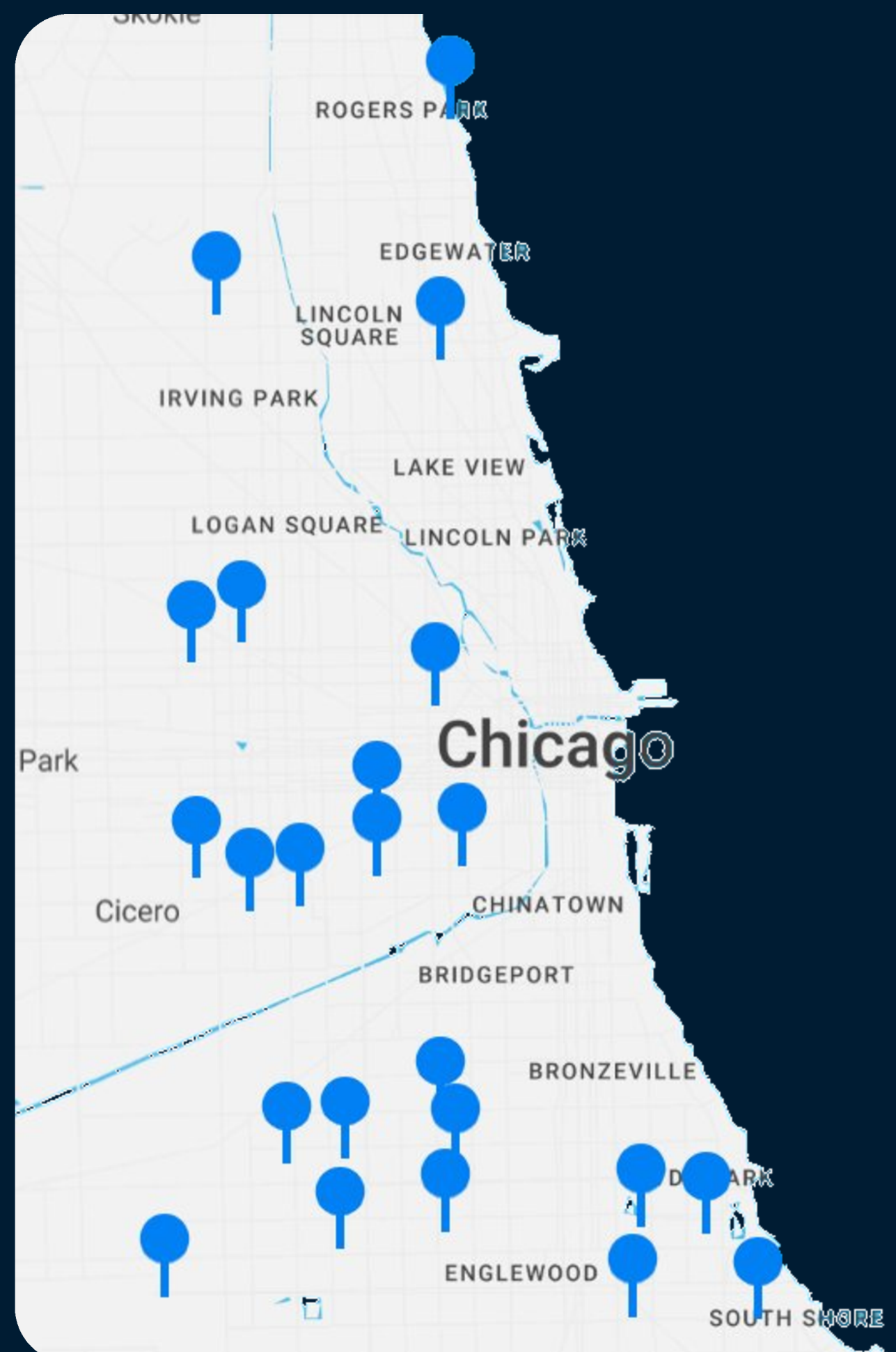
Program Overview

Fight Like a Girl exists to solve three problems: limited access to sport for girls, rising mental health challenges for girls, and declining confidence and self esteem for girls.

Boxing Fundamentals: We teach boxing fundamentals and strength and conditioning to help girls build power, athleticism, and unshakable confidence through movement.

Fighter's Mindset Curriculum: Our signature 20-week curriculum teaches girls to transfer the discipline and resilience they build in boxing into every area of their lives.

Social Emotional Learning: Every practice is built around developing confidence, healthy habits, and a growth mindset in and out of the gym.



What is Fight Like a Girl?

Fight Like a Girl (FLAG) is Box United’s signature afterschool program for girls in grades 4-12. It pairs structured boxing instruction with an evidence-informed social-emotional learning curriculum called the Fighter’s Mindset. The result is a program unlike anything else available in Chicago schools: one that builds physical strength, mental resilience, and a lasting belief in what girls are capable of.



**20
weeks**

Full Program
Year

**2x a
week**

Session
Frequency

**60-90
min**

Per Session

**Up to
20**

Participants
per Site

**Grades
4-12**

Eligible
Participants

The Fighter’s Mindset Curriculum

Every FLAG session opens with a Coach Message and an intention-setting practice, then moves into boxing skill instruction. The SEL curriculum is woven directly into the physical training, not layered on top of it. Girls learn about growth mindset while working through a burnout round. They are practicing peer feedback while training on combinations. The curriculum is built around three core pillars:

Confidence

Girls build belief in themselves as movers, learners, and leaders. Boxing is the vehicle. The belief that they are capable is the destination.

Growth Mindset

Girls learn that ability is not fixed. They practice persisting through difficulty, embracing challenge, and applying that mindset outside the gym.

Healthy Habits

Girls build physical wellness routines, develop a positive relationship with their bodies, and learn to manage stress through preparation and self-care.

How the Partnership Works

Fight Like a Girl runs on a Train-the-Trainer model. Box United does not place our own coaches in your school. Instead, your school identifies a staff member, teacher, aide, or trusted community adult to become the FLAG coach. We train that person completely, provide the curriculum, deliver all equipment, and support them throughout the season. This model is intentional: it builds capacity inside your school and ensures the program is led by someone who already knows and trusts your students.

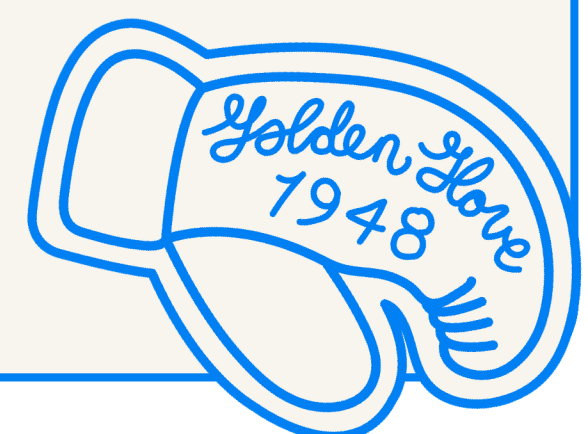
For schools that are unable to source their own coach, Box United can help identify and fund a stipended coach from our network. This is factored into the partnership conversation and the scholarship tier process.

Box United Provides

- Full coach training through our Train-the-Trainer model
- The Fighter's Mindset SEL curriculum (20 lessons across a fall and spring season)
- All boxing equipment, including student journals
- Coach stipends for schools that cannot source their own
- Ongoing coaching support, quality assurance, and site visits
- Attendance tracking and bi-weekly session reporting
- End-of-season participant surveys and impact data
- Program coordination and partner communication throughout the year
- Online registration portal and printed documents

Partner School Provides

- A coach or staff member to be trained and run the program on-site
- A designated indoor space for sessions (gym, multi-purpose room, etc.)
- Secure storage for equipment accessible to the coach daily
- A school contact who coordinates logistics with our team
- Active support recruiting girls in grades 4-12
- A minimum enrollment of 10 participants per site



What to Expect Season to Season

- Before the season begins, Box United staff will meet with you to confirm logistics, session days and times, and enrollment targets.
- Registration open for families with online and paper options available. We recruit girls in grades 4 through 12 with a target of 10 to 20 participants per site.
- Coaches are trained by Box United staff before the first fall session and before the first spring session. Training consists of online modules and in-person elements. All coaches complete background checks to comply with Box United's Child Protection Policy.
- At the end of each season, participants complete surveys, fitness assessments, and lightweight mind-body measures. Coaches submit feedback, and parents are invited to respond to an optional survey. All data is aggregated and no individual student data is shared publicly.
- Box United will work to establish a formal data sharing agreement with your school or district before Session 1 begins, renewed each year. This gives us access to attendance, GPA, PE performance, and disciplinary data that surveys alone cannot capture.

Expected Outcomes

FLAG is built around a formal theory of Change with a three-year rotating research focus. We measure what matters, and we share those results with our school partners. Here is what the data and the framework tell us to expect across three time horizons:

By End of Session 1

- Basic boxing fundamentals: stance, jab, cross, hook, footwork
- Personal intention-setting practice
- Team SMART goal development and achievement plan created
- 10-punch combination performed in front of peers
- Introduction to healthy prep habits: gear, nutrition, sleep

By End of Year

- 20-move boxing combination performed with confidence
- Individual SMART goals set and tracked
- Growth mindset strategies applied in and out of the gym
- Positive self-talk and peer feedback skills practiced
- Stronger sense of belonging and athletic identity

Long-Term (3-5 yr.)

- Measurably increased confidence in self-expression, movement, and decision-making
- Durable relationship with physical activity and sport
- Bone density built during the critical adolescent window
- Resilience and persistence when facing adversity
- Peer network rooted in shared challenge and growth
- See themselves as athletes, leaders, and champions

How the Partnership Works

We believe every girl in Chicago should have access to Fight Like a Girl regardless of her school’s budget. That belief is not just a mission statement. It is built directly into how we structure our partnerships.

The true cost of running a full 20-week FLAG program at one school is \$10,000.

This covers coaching staff, equipment, curriculum materials, training, and program coordination for the full year.

Box United has transitioned to a tier-based partnership model. Every prospective school partner is evaluated through a needs-based matrix that considers school demographic data, community need indicators, and available funding. This process determines which tier your school falls into and what financial contribution, if any, is expected.

This is not a pay-to-play model. Schools with the highest need are a top priority, and we work to actively secure grant funding to serve them at no cost.

Scholarship Tier	School Pays	Box United Covers	Coach Stipend
Tier 1: Full Scholarship	\$0	\$10,000	Covered by Box United
Tier 2: 75% Scholarship	\$2,500	\$7,500	Covered by Box United
Tier 3: 50% Scholarship	\$5,000	\$5,000	School or shared
Tier 4: 25% Scholarship	\$7,500	\$2,500	School or shared
Tier 5: No Scholarship	\$10,000	\$0	School provides

How the Needs-Based Matrix Works

When you express interest in Fight Like a Girl, Box United completes a brief internal assessment using information you share with us and publicly available data about your school. We look at three things:

- **Need:** Free and reduced lunch rate, R3 zone designation, and the number of girls enrolled in grades 4 through 12.
- **Capacity:** Whether you have space available twice per week, one or two staff members willing to be trained as FLAG coaches, and an after-school schedule that can accommodate 60 to 90-minute sessions.
- **Financial Fit:** Your current OST budget, what you are willing to contribute toward the program, and whether a funding source, such as CSI funding, is available to cover coach pay.

Each of these areas is scored, and the total determines your scholarship tier placement. We share findings with you before any decisions are finalized, and no school is placed into a tier without a conversation first.

A note on schools that don't fit neatly into a tier:

We recognize that not every school situation maps cleanly to a scholarship percentage. If your school has unique funding constraints, partial resources, or a non-traditional structure, we want to hear about it. Box United is willing to work through creative arrangements on a case-by-case basis. The matrix guides our process; it does not end it.

Ready to Learn More?

We would love to talk with you about what FLAG could look like at your school. Here is how to get started:

- **Complete our school interest survey.** This short form gives us the foundational information we need to assess fit and prepare for a meaningful first conversation.
- **Schedule a 30-minute call with our team.** We will walk through your matrix results, explain scholarship tier placement, discuss a potential start date, and talk through coach recruitment at your school.

From there, Box United will prepare a partnership proposal outlining session logistics, cost, and a timeline for getting started.

